

WORKED EXAMPLE

Jack Mo reads it aloud

Facade scaffold over walk

THE UNTRAINED EYE vs THE RISK MANAGER'S EYE



Jack Mo circles what his eye lands on — and the one thing that should be there and isn't.

To a passing eye this is just progress — a building wrapped in scaffolding, planks and crews working the face in good light, the job clearly moving. The casual eye reads the height as ambition and keeps walking, right along the sidewalk at the base. A risk manager reads it in two glances and feels their stomach drop. First they look UP: workers, tools, and loose material are stacked story after story on the open face. Then they look straight DOWN the same vertical line — and there is the public walk, directly under everything that could fall. Now they hunt for the three things that protect the people in between: toe-boards at every platform edge, debris netting down the face, a covered walkway over the sidewalk. The casual eye sees scaffolding and thinks the building is protected. The trained eye sees scaffolding and asks who is protected from it — because a dropped wrench from the tenth lift does not care that the crew is certified, and a scaffold is only as safe as the day it was erected and last inspected. One incident beside a public way and the regulators arrive, the job stops, and the whole site goes quiet. The scene did not change between those two readings. The eye did.

THIS SCENE FEEDS YOUR REGISTER

R15 • R19 • R23 • R27 • R31 — the five students dealt this scene.

The discipline under that read

The moves you run so you can see it too — then five register rows fall out of one glance.

- LOOK

sweep overhead → working level → ground/openings → edges → background (don't lock on the obvious).
- SPLIT

say what you SEE — facts only: A multi-story building wrapped front-to-top in tube-and-coupler scaffolding, Work platforms, planks, and loose material stacked on the open building face, Workers and tools positioned high on the upper lifts.
- NOTICE

circle the cues: Platform edges on the upper lifts — checked for toe-boards; The full face of the scaffold — checked for debris netting; The line where the scaffold base meets the sidewalk — and the missing No covered walkway over the sidewalk and no debris netting on the face — the one barrier that would catch a dropped object before it reaches the public is missing, leaving an open vertical gap from the top lift straight down to people on the walk.
- ASK → PROJECT

what releases it, who's in the path, what happens next — and in which phase.
- NAME · five rows, born from one glance (cause → event → consequence)

- 1

Safety

Because tools and loose material sit on platform edges with no toe-boards or debris netting, a dropped object may fall the full height of the face, leading to a serious injury to a pedestrian on the walk below.
Owner: Site Safety Manager · Trigger: Daily scaffold inspection checklist shows a missing toe-board, net section, or covered-walkway segment on any lift over the public way.
- 2

Safety

Because crews work high on the open face of the scaffold, a worker may lose footing or balance at an unguarded edge, leading to a fall from height and a serious worker injury.
- 3

Safety

Because a scaffold is only as safe as it was erected and inspected, an undetected erection or connection defect may cause a partial scaffold collapse, leading to multiple casualties on the platform and the ground below.
- 4

Schedule

Because an incident next to a public way triggers regulator response, an OSHA stop-work order may be issued, leading to a full site shutdown and lost days across every trade until clearance.
- 5

Safety

Because the public walk runs directly under the work, an unprotected pedestrian may be struck by a falling object or debris, leading to the highest-stakes liability and reputational exposure on the job.

READING MOVE · bank this card

“Whenever work is over a public way, look UP then straight DOWN the same line — and ask what protects the people in between. If the toe-boards, netting, or covered walkway are missing, that open gap is your first risk.”

SUCCESS CARD · check the read against these six

- ☐ a real, visible cue

☐ cause is a site condition

☐ a future event

☐ consequence on cost/time/quality/safety
- ☐ owner + early-warning trigger

☐ (M4) P and I each defended